SRM UNIVERSITY – *AP*, ANDHRA PRADESH

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PLAGIARISM POLICY OF SRM UNIVERSITY – *AP*

1. Introduction

'Plagiarism' is the unacknowledged use of another person's work as one's own work. Plagiarism involves copying of phrases, clauses, sentences, paragraphs, or longer extracts from published or unpublished work including from internet without acknowledgement of the source The purpose of this policy is to ensure and establish a framework based on some universal ethical and policy guidelines to deter, detect, and deal with plagiarism in all forms, to be adopted for faculty and researchers across all disciplines of **SRM UNIVERSITY-AP, Andhra Pradesh.**

2. Definition

In these regulations, unless the context otherwise requires

a. "**Academic Integrity**" is the intellectual honesty in proposing, performing and reporting any activity, which leads to the creation of intellectual property;

b. "**Author**" includes a student or a faculty or a researcher or staff of SRM UNIVERSITY-AP who claims to be the creator of the work under consideration;

c. "**Common Knowledge**" means a well-known fact, quote, figure or information that is known to most of the people;

d. "**Degree**" means any such degree specified by the University Grants Commission, by notification in the Official Gazette, under section 22 of the University Grants Commission Act, 1956;

e. "**Student**" means a person duly admitted and pursuing a programme of study including a research programme in any mode of study (full time or part-time or distance mode).

f. "**Faculty**" refers to a person who is teaching and/or guiding students enrolled in an SRM University-AP in any capacity whatsoever i.e., regular, ad-hoc, guest, temporary,

visiting etc.,

g. "**Staff**" means regular non-teaching staff of SRM University -AP.

h. **Vice-Chancellor** means the Vice-Chancellor of SRM University -AP

i. **Dean (Research)** means Dean (Research) of SRM University -AP.

j. "**SRM UNIVERSITY-AP**" means a university recognized under section 2(f) of the UGC Act, 1956.

k. "**Plagiarism**" means the practice of taking someone else's work or idea and passing them as one's own.

l. "**Programme**" means a programme of study leading to the award of a bachelor's, master's and research level degree;

m. "**Researcher**" refers to a person conducting academic / scientific research in SRM UNIVERSITY-AP;

n. "**Departmental Academic Integrity Panel** (DAIP)" shall mean the body constituted at the departmental level to investigate allegations of plagiarism.

o. "**Institutional Academic Integrity Panel** (IAIP)" shall mean the body constituted at Institutional level to consider recommendations of the departmental academic integrity panel and take appropriate decisions in respect of allegations of plagiarism and decide on penalties to be imposed. In exceptional cases, it shall investigate allegations of plagiarism at the institutional level;

p. "**Manuscript**" includes research paper, thesis, dissertation, chapters in books, full-fledged books and any other similar work, submitted for assessment / opinion leading to the award of master and research level degrees or publication in print or electronic media by students or faculty or researcher or staff of an SRM UNIVERSITY-AP; however, this shall exclude assignments / term papers / project reports / course work / essays and answer scripts etc.,

q. "**Source**" means the published primary and secondary material from any source whatsoever and includes written information and opinions gained directly from other people, including eminent scholars, public figures and practitioners in any form whatsoever as also data and information in the electronic form be it audio, video, image or text; Information being given the same meaning as defined under Section 2 (1) (v) of the Information Technology Act, 2000 and reproduced here in Regulation 2

(l);

r. "**Year**" means the academic session in which a proven offence has been committed.

3. **Methods of Plagiarism**:

a) Directly quoting another person's language, data, illustration, tables, etc. without due acknowledgment of the source.
b) Copying a section of a book/article/report/monograph/dissertation/thesis without proper citation.
c) Buying, stealing, or borrowing assignments, experiments/results.
d) Paragraphing the work of others without due acknowledgment.
e) Using ideas of someone else without crediting the originator.
f) Copying, cutting, and pasting from the internet or online source and submitting as one's own work without giving proper reference/citation.

Self-plagiarism is defined as the reproduction, in part or whole of one's own previously published workwithout adequate citation and proper acknowledgment and claiming the most recent work as new andoriginal for any academic advantage. If the contents of own published, accepted, or submitted work are used in a thesis, the same should be clearly specified at the beginning of the adopted material in the thesis. If the publication involves multiple co-authors, the role of other authors should be clearly specified.

The core work shall include an abstract with keywords, introduction, objective, hypothesis, research methodology, analysis and interpretation, summary and observations, conclusions, recommendations, and references. In lieu of the ethics in higher education, fair conduct of research and prevention of misconduct, as per UGC (Promotion of Academic Integrity and Prevention of Plagiarism in Higher Educational Institutions) Regulations, 2018, students, researchers, and faculty members should not perform any academic misconduct by the theft of intellectual property in any manner. Therefore, the proper attribution, seeking permission of the author wherever necessary, and acknowledgment of source compatible with the needs and specificities

of disciplines and in accordance with rules and regulations governing the source is essentially required.

4. Curbing Plagiarism

a. A Student/Faculty/Staff must check the document through university-approved software to ensure that documents such as thesis, dissertation, publications, or any other such documents are free of plagiarism at the time of their submission.
b. Every student submitting a thesis, dissertation, project report or any other such documents to the universityshall submit an undertaking indicating that the document has been prepared by him/her and that the document is his/her original work and free of any plagiarism. The undertaking shall include the fact that the document has been duly checked through a Plagiarism detection toolapproved by the university.
c. Plagiarism check report generated through software along with the certificate of plagiarism check(mentioning level of plagiarism) shall be attached while submitting the document to the university.
d. The student shall submit a soft copy of B. Tech. Project report /masters' / research program's dissertation / Ph. D. thesis to the university so that the same can be submitted to INFLIBNET within a month after the award of degrees for hosting in the digital repository under the "**Shodhganga**" e-repository.

5. Similarity

Similarity checks for exclusion from Plagiarism: The similarity checks for plagiarism shall exclude the following –

- All quoted work reproduced with all necessary permission and/or attribution.
- All references, bibliography, table of contents, preface, and acknowledgments.
- All generic terms, laws, standard symbols, and standard equations.

Note 1:

The research work carried out by the student, faculty, researcher, and staff shall be based on original ideas, which shall include abstract, summary, hypothesis, observations, results, conclusions, and recommendations only and shall not have any

similarities. **It shall exclude common knowledge or coincidental terms, up to ten (10) consecutive words.**

6. Levels of Plagiarism

Plagiarism is quantified into the following levels in ascending order of severity for the purpose of its definition:

a. Level 0: Similarities up to 10%
b. Level 1: Similarities above 10% to 40%
c. Level 2: Similarities above 40% to 60%
d. Level 3: Similarities above 60%

7. Penalties

Penalties in the cases of plagiarism shall be imposed on students pursuing studies at the level of Masters and Research programs and on researcher, faculty & staff of the SRM UNIVERSITY-AP only after academic misconduct on the part of the individual has been established without doubt, when all avenues of appeal have been exhausted and individual in question has been provided enough opportunity to defend himself or herself in a fair or transparent manner.

7.1. Penalties in case of plagiarism in submission of thesis and dissertations

Institutional Academic Integrity Panel (IAIP) shall impose penalty considering the severity of the Plagiarism.

a. **Level 0: Similarities up to 10%** - Minor Similarities, no penalty.
b. **Level 1: Similarities above 10% to 40%** - Such student shall be asked to submit a revised manuscript within a stipulated period not exceeding 6 months.
c. **Level 2: Similarities above 40% to 60%** - Such student shall be debarred from submitting a revised manuscript for a period of one year.
d. **Level 3: Similarities above 60%** - Registration of student for that programme shall be cancelled.

Note 2: Penalty on repeated plagiarism- Such student shall be punished for the plagiarism of one level higher than the previous level committed by him/her. In case where plagiarism of highest level is committed then the punishment for the same shall be operative.

Note 3: Penalty in case where the degree/credit has already been obtained - If plagiarism is proved on a date later than the date of award of degree or credit as the case may be then his/her degree or credit shall be put in abeyance for a period recommended by the IAIP and approved by the Vice Chancellor.

Note 4: "The inclusion of an article published in a SCOPUS/WoS/ABDC indexed journal in a thesis or dissertation is exempt from plagiarism concerns. Candidate can download a supporting document outlining the journal's policy for including published articles in the thesis and submit it to the Controller of Examination Office of SRM UNIVERSITY-AP."

7.2. Penalties in case of plagiarism in academic and research publications

Note 5: Each journal has its own plagiarism policy. If that is, follow and no objection from journals is obtained, then following penalties will be considered for the below criteria.

I. **Level 0: Similarities up to 10%** - Minor similarities, no penalty.

II. **Level 1: Similarities above 10% to 40%**

i) Similarities above 10% to 20% - Shall be discussed and decided by Dean-Research about the withdrawal of document, following the journal policy and journal ranking as per SCIMAGO.

ii) Similarities above 20% to 40% - Shall be asked to withdraw the manuscript

III. **Level 2: Similarities above 40% to 60%**

i) Shall be asked to withdraw the manuscript

ii) If Faculty/Staff, shall be denied a right to one annual increment.

iii) If Faculty/Staff, shall not be allowed to be a supervisor to any new Master's, M.Phil., Ph.D. Student/scholar for a period of two years.

iv) If Student, then shall be debarred from submitting manuscript for a period of one year.

IV. **Level 3: Similarities above 60%**

i) Shall be asked to withdraw manuscript.

ii) If Faculty/Staff, shall be denied a right to two successive annual increments.

iii) If Faculty/Staff, shall not be allowed to be a supervisor to any new Master's, M.Phil., Ph.D. Student/scholar for a period of three years.

iv) If Student, then shall be debarred from submitting manuscript for a period of three year.

Note 6: Penalty on repeated plagiarism - Shall be asked to withdraw manuscript and shall be punished for the plagiarism of one level higher than the lower level committed by him/her. In case where plagiarism of highest level is committed then the punishment for the same shall be operative. In case level 3 offence is repeated then the disciplinary action including suspension/termination as per service rules shall be taken by the SRM UNIVERSITY-AP.

Note 7: Penalty in case where the benefit or credit has already been obtained - If plagiarism is proved on a date later than the date of benefit or credit obtained then his/her benefit or credit shall be put in abeyance for a period recommended by IAIP and approved by the Head of the Institution

Note 8: SRM UNIVERSITY-APs shall create a mechanism to ensure that each of the paper publication/thesis/dissertation by the student, faculty, researcher, or staff of the SRM UNIVERSITY-AP is checked for plagiarism at the time of forwarding/submission.

Note 9: If there is any complaint of plagiarism against the Head of Department/Authorities at the institutional level, a suitable action, in line with these regulations, shall be recommended by the IAIP and approved by the Competent Authority.

Note 10: If there is any complaint of plagiarism against any member of DAIP or IAIP, then such member shall excuse himself / herself from the meeting(s) where his/her case is being discussed/investigated.

8. **Removal of Difficulty**

Dean-Research reserves the right to remove difficulty/difficulties in the course of implementations of these Regulations in consultation Vice-Chancellor.

9. **Necessary Precautions**

Besides, in case the one who has been claimed for plagiarism and has been found accused of doing so shall be subject to the court of law by the one who has claimed for penalty as per copyright norm. Keeping in view the policy of plagiarism, and avoid piracy of intellectual property, the author needs to follow the citation policy:

- When 10 words are taken together from some established core work, citation becomes essential.
- Also, when the copied content reaches 40 words in accumulation, the fragment needs to be kept under an inverted comma ("_") in italics.
- Authors are necessarily required to cite references in case of any content adopted from anywhere other than internet open sites. It is also that, even in the case of open site internet source the copied contents if found more than 30 percent in aggregate during plagiarism detection, the work shall not be considered for further proceedings.

Note 1: Any point or matter not covered in this document or the exemption can be considered by the **Vice Chancellor, SRM University-AP**.

Note 2: The policy framed is in line with the provisions stated under **UGC Regulation 2018 for Plagiarism,** therefore, it may change with amendments in UGC Regulation.

Registrar

Dr. R. PREMKUMAR
REGISTRAR
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